

pull, while the broader mystery of Carcosa adds cosmic dread. The planet is not just hostile terrain. It is a place that bends memory, space, and expectation. Audio logs, holograms, base camp conversations, and environmental fragments drip-feed the story rather than laying it out in clean cinematic blocks. That structure works when the game lets the mystery breathe, but it also means the narrative can feel staccato. There are moments where a major emotional beat appears between runs, then the player is immediately shoved back into combat before it fully lands.

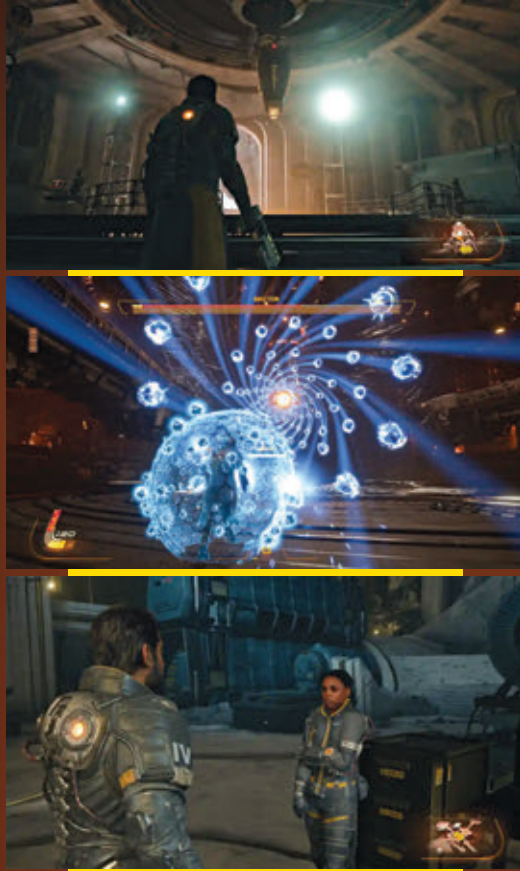
The better parts of the writing lean into obsession and trauma. Arjun's history, his strained relationship with Nitya, his professional guilt, and the suggestion of alcoholism give the story a jagged personal texture. Carcosa shifts around Arjun in a way that feels less like level randomisation and more like a physical expression of his mental state.

Supporting characters such as Sheridan help add structure to the base camp, and Jane Perry brings weight to the command presence. Still, this is Arjun's game.

GRAPHICS

Visually, Saros is a showpiece, but not in the clean postcard imagery sense. It is beautiful in a hostile, abrasive, half-decayed way. Carcosa is full of ancient alien ruins, metallic corridors, eerie biomes, shifting architecture, and spaces that feel engineered by something that is only pretending to understand human geometry.

The art direction sits somewhere between biomechanical horror and neon arcade excess. Muted alien surfaces are constantly interrupted by bright projectiles, sparks, dust, molten heat, and enemy death



effects. Combat regularly becomes a kaleidoscope of particle effects, but the important trick is that the game usually remains readable. The bullets need to look spectacular without becoming visual noise, and Housemarque mostly gets that balance perfectly right.

Lighting does a lot of heavy lifting. The eclipse mechanic gives the world a stronger visual identity than a simple day-night shift would have. Shadows stretch, arenas take on a more oppressive tone, and the atmosphere becomes more menacing as the world reacts around Arjun. It is not just a visual gimmick, it ties directly into the game's mood and mechanics.

While we didn't play the game on the PS5 Pro, Saros appears to benefit meaningfully from the newer PSSR support. Housemarque says it upgraded the game's PSSR implementation to a newer version released in March 2026, with the aim of producing a sharper image that comes close to native 4K presentation. A lot of the improvements

will only be made clear once you pixel peep.

Fast-moving projectiles, reflections, fine geometric detail, and shadow clarity all feel fluid and don't break immersion. Some facial animation can look a little uncanny, and there are minor moments where procedural spaces reveal their construction, but these do not meaningfully hurt the overall visual impact.

SOUND

The sound design is one of Saros' strongest technical achievements. This is not a game where 3D audio is merely something that is nice to have. It is genuinely useful. In larger encounters, threats come from every direction possible, and being able to locate enemies,

projectiles, teleporting attackers, and incoming hazards by sound can make the difference between a clean dodge and a dead run.

Carcosa itself sounds alive in the worst possible way. Metallic groans, alien shrieks, wind, radio distortion, and low-frequency environmental rumbles make the planet feel unstable. The soundscape becomes more aggressive during intense combat and eclipse phases, while quieter moments use space well enough to create unease without constantly shouting at the player.

Weapon audio deserves a special mention. Each gun and power weapon has a distinct auditory kick, which helps combat feel tactile even before the DualSense haptics get involved. Successful shield use has clear feedback, pickups have satisfying pings, and the low-health state smartly narrows the sound field to reinforce panic. *

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